

DELHI | Junking Missiles

Bajaj Auto and the Indian Army have something in common. The two-wheeler maker is worrying about the fate of three scooter factories where it is halting production. The army, meanwhile, is concerned about phasing out the backbone of its anti-tank capability: nearly 12,000 Russian-made Konkurs anti-tank missiles which have reached the end of their 10-year shelf life. The Master General Ordnance has decided to dispose the 1-metre missile in depots across the country after the solid rocket fuel in them reached the end of its service life. The 1970s era wire-guided missiles, designed to smash



THE KONKURS MISSILE LAUNCHER

battle tanks, have already completed a 10-year life upgrade. Further extensions are deemed unsafe. The missiles could be used as gunnery targets—fired as airborne targets for anti-aircraft guns—but the worry is they could explode while being fired. *by Sandeep Unnithan*

BUZZ
OF THE WEEK

Minister of Overseas Indian Affairs Vayalar Ravi got a taste of crime in Africa on a recent trip to Liberia. After a car accident, his "rescuers" took off with his wallet, handbag and even some of the clothes he was wearing.

KOLKATA | Back to the Wall



MANEESH AGNIHOTRI/www.indiatodayimages.com

Even with 7,000 paramilitary personnel at its disposal, the West Bengal Government's inefficiency to take on the Maoists is apparent. Shortly after the Maoist strike at the Eastern Frontier Rifles (EFR) camp in Silda in Midnapore district that left 25 jawans dead, Director-General of Police Bhupinder

BODIES LINED UP AFTER THE SILDA MAOIST ATTACK

Singh said it was an intelligence failure on the part of the force. He added that the police camps in the district may be relocated as the locals were not cooperating with the force and to avoid civilian casualties. On the other hand, Maoist leader Kishanji is smug. He claims that the police is making "hollow noises" by saying that they were about to catch him when he has been evading arrest. The Maoists are also readying for prolonged and sudden strikes. The CPI(M) Politburo has recently set up a separate cell to counter such strikes by the Maoists with only the top leadership aware of the plans. *by Abhijit Dasgupta*

MUMBAI | Charging On

The conclusion of the India Today Woman Summit and Awards was marked by acts of grace and stories of inspiration. Vidya Balan delivered the dinner keynote address and awards in place of the hospitalised Aishwarya Rai Bachchan, while Abhishek Bachchan came to collect an award on her behalf.

MANDAR DEODHAR/www.indiatodayimages.com



INDIA TODAY Editor-in-Chief Aroon Purie said, "This is a generation of women who have truly taken charge. May the next generation not only look up at them but also realise the importance of the role they have played." The India Today Woman of the Year was Rukhsana Kausar, newly appointed constable of the J&K Police, for resisting and killing a militant in Rajouri last year. It's getting to be a gutsy new women's world out there.